

S02-L5 — Concrete, Kinetic, and Fiber: Latin American Geometry and Its Markets

Summary

Mid-twentieth-century Latin American geometric abstraction splits into two distinct lineages worth keeping separate in a sales conversation: Brazilian Neo-Concretism, which broke with the fixed object to activate the work through the viewer's body, and Venezuelan kineticism, which activates the work through the viewer's optical movement in front of it. A third axis, Olga de Amaral's work in fiber and weaving, applies the same geometric logic to a different medium and is today the group's strongest market case, with a record sustained by several repeated sales following an institutional retrospective. The contrast comes from Gego, whose museum recognition is just as strong but whose auction market has not yet shown the same repetition. The note closes with the collectors and New York and Miami institutions that sustain this circuit's visibility.

1. Brazilian Neo-Concretism

Neo-Concretism emerged in Rio de Janeiro in the late 1950s as a break from São Paulo's orthodox Concretism, which treated the work as a closed, self-sufficient geometric object. Lygia Clark instead proposed manipulable objects, her *Bichos*, hinged metal plates the viewer folds and unfolds by hand. Her auction record is *Bicho invertebrado*, sold at Phillips New York on November 21, 2013, for [1,865,000 dollars](#).¹ Hélio Oiticica carried the same idea to the whole body with his *Parangolés*, textile capes meant to be worn and moved in. His record is *P31 Parangolé, capa 24, Escrebuto*, sold at Phillips New York on November 16, 2017, for [615,000 dollars](#).² Lygia Pape completes the trio with work that crosses the book, light, and collective participation. Her record is *Twelve Elements from The Night and Day Book (Book of Light)*, sold at Phillips New York on May 29, 2014, for [461,000 dollars](#).³ In all three cases, the movement's historical importance far outpaces its visible secondary-market depth, because major works surface at auction very infrequently.

2. Venezuelan Kineticism

In parallel, in Venezuela, Jesús Rafael Soto and Carlos Cruz-Diez developed a distinct language within the same geometry, kinetic art, where the work changes according to the viewing angle or the viewer's physical movement in front of it, rather than through direct tactile manipulation. Soto's record is *La Scie a Metaux (The Hacksaw)*, sold at Sotheby's New York on November 19, 2012, for [1,082,500 dollars](#).⁴ Cruz-Diez's sits in 2018, at Sotheby's, at approximately [879,000 dollars](#), though the available public listing does not disclose the full title or the exact date of the sale.⁵ Both markets combine recognizable international liquidity with the need to carefully segment between unique works, major kinetic structures, and editions, since the three segments do not behave the same way on price.

3. Fiber as Geometry: Olga de Amaral

The group's clearest market case is Colombian artist Olga de Amaral, who applies the same geometric discipline to weaving and fiber instead of metal or oil paint. Her record is *Pueblo H*, sold at Christie's New York on November 19, 2025, for [3,125,000 dollars](#).⁶ That result did not stand alone: between May 2025 and March 2026, at least six sales of her textile works are documented in a range of [698,500 to 3,125,000 dollars](#), spread across several houses.⁷ The institutional backdrop is a retrospective at the Paris [Fondation Cartier](#), the Cartier group's private contemporary art foundation, held during 2024 and 2025.⁸ That sequence, retrospective first, then price acceleration and repeated results, is the strongest evidence available today that museum recognition actually translated into real market depth.

4. The Contrast: Gego

Gego, the artistic name of German-Venezuelan artist Gertrud Goldschmidt, worked geometry through nets and wire structures suspended in space. Her most cited piece, *Columna Reticulárea*, sold at Sotheby's New York on May 25, 2017, for a reported price of [1,512,500 dollars](#), though the available public source does not disclose the full realized-price detail.⁹ Unlike Amaral, recent public evidence for Gego is insufficient to establish a market trend, despite recorded sale activity as recently as 2023.¹⁰ The contrast between the two artists lies not in institutional prestige, which is comparable, but in the quantity and homogeneity of the auction results available to measure direction.

5. Who Sustains the Institutional Map

Behind these markets sits a small circuit of collectors who combine private acquisition with museum philanthropy. Patricia Phelps de Cisneros, Venezuelan-

born, sits as a current trustee of MoMA and founded the museum's Latin American and Caribbean Fund in 2006 to support regional acquisitions.¹¹ Jorge M. Pérez holds an equivalent structural relationship with the Pérez Art Museum Miami, to which he donated 82 works by 58 artists in December 2025.¹² Eugenio López Alonso founded the Fundación Jumex Arte Contemporáneo in Mexico City in 2001, which sustains the Museo Jumex and its own curatorial program.¹³ Eduardo Costantini, founder of MALBA in Buenos Aires, dramatically expanded his collection's scope on December 15, 2025, by acquiring Daros Latinamerica, a set of 1,233 works by 117 artists.¹⁴ All four operate as verifiable nodes between private collecting and institutional validation, the same logic that explains why Amaral and Gego share museum prestige without yet sharing the same market outcome.

For the Conversation with Clients

When a client lumps Neo-Concretism and kineticism into the same sentence, it helps to clarify upfront that they share an era and a region but not an activation mechanism, one triggers through the body and the other through shifting vision, and that distinction changes how each piece reads in a room. When a client assumes that any work tied to a prestigious collection name, whether Cisneros, Pérez, Jumex, or Malba, rises in price automatically, it helps to separate institutional validation, which is real and verifiable, from that specific piece's resale track record, which has to be checked case by case. And in a direct comparison between Amaral and Gego, the price gap does not diminish either artist's artistic standing, it only describes how much public resale evidence exists for each one today.

References

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